

Make it sound like you.

Completely accurate and completely useless. Correct, flat, and written like an encyclopedia. There is a one-time fix.

THE SHIFT

Out of the box it is writing for nobody in particular, so it writes like a textbook. It does not know whether you are a supervisor with four minutes between meetings or an analyst who wants every number. **Nobody ever told it.**

Find where it takes standing instructions

Sometimes it is a setting for the whole tool. Sometimes it lives inside the workspace. Poke around, you will find it.

It is not code. You just talk to it.

Tell it who you are and how to talk to you

Who you are, what to skip, what to lead with.

Speak to me like a sharp colleague, not a textbook. Lead with the bottom line. Skip the jargon.

It applies to everything after

Every summary, every draft, every breakdown follows those rules from then on.

The difference between rewriting it first and forwarding it as is.

TWO HABITS THAT MAKE IT SHARPER

Give each workspace one job

Do not pile everything into one. One for a project, one for a topic. Focused sources give sharp answers. A junk drawer gives junk drawer answers.

Steer each piece before it is made

Most tools give you a chance to say what this particular summary should cover, who is reading it, and how long it should be. Skipping that is the top reason people get generic results.

The honest part

This does not make it perfect. It makes it yours. You still read what it gives you before it goes anywhere with your name on it.

Where to find it. Custom instructions in ChatGPT, or the instructions box in a Gem, Project, or Copilot agent.

YOUR CHALLENGE THIS WEEK

Find where your tool takes standing instructions and tell it how you want to be spoken to. Then run a document you have already run through it.

Read the two side by side. Same tool, same document. The only thing that changed is that you introduced yourself.

Before you send anything, read it. You are the pilot. AI is the co-pilot. Every decision still goes through you.

Next episode · **The message you have been putting off.** The hard email, and how to know how it will land.

YOUR ORGANIZATION NAME
AND LOGO